University of Strathclyde Business School



GLASGOW CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

INSIGHTFUL SOLUTIONS CONSULTING GROUP

Consulting Report

Group 15

Amirali Mazloom Attar (202389271)

Sanjeevani Jatoth(202392079)

Sharni Anand Vimala (202389302)

Bibinandh Ananthakrishnan(202388718)

Kaushal Bobade(202393594)

Parth Lakhina (202363508)

Olafimihan Dorcas Kikelomo(202389066)

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report strategically guides the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce towards its imperative goals, intertwining digital innovation, community engagement, and strategic partnerships. We commence with a comprehensive analysis, spotlighting the youth, enhancing membership engagement, and fostering a robust support ecosystem. The SWOT analysis emphasizes the pivotal roles of universities and start-ups. The proposed initiatives encompass innovative membership tiers, a dynamic student ambassador program, a podcast initiative, a Chamber app, and events to spur innovation and economic growth.

INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND: NAVIGATING PARAMOUNT OBJECTIVES

Our consulting team, addressing the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce's strategic imperatives, focuses on three paramount objectives.

Objective 1: Fostering Connection with the Youth

Recognizing the evolving business landscape, the Chamber aspires to connect with the younger demographic. Our innovative strategies prioritize cutting-edge communication channels, social media, and tailored events, aligning with the preferences of the dynamic younger audience.

Objective 2: Elevating Engagement Across Membership Spectrum

Central to the Chamber's vision is augmenting engagement across all members. Our crafted recommendations transcend generational and sectoral boundaries, ensuring every member feels integral. Initiatives encompass networking, knowledge sharing, and collaborative endeavours, fostering a vibrant and interconnected ecosystem.

Objective 3: Cultivating an Ecosystem of Support

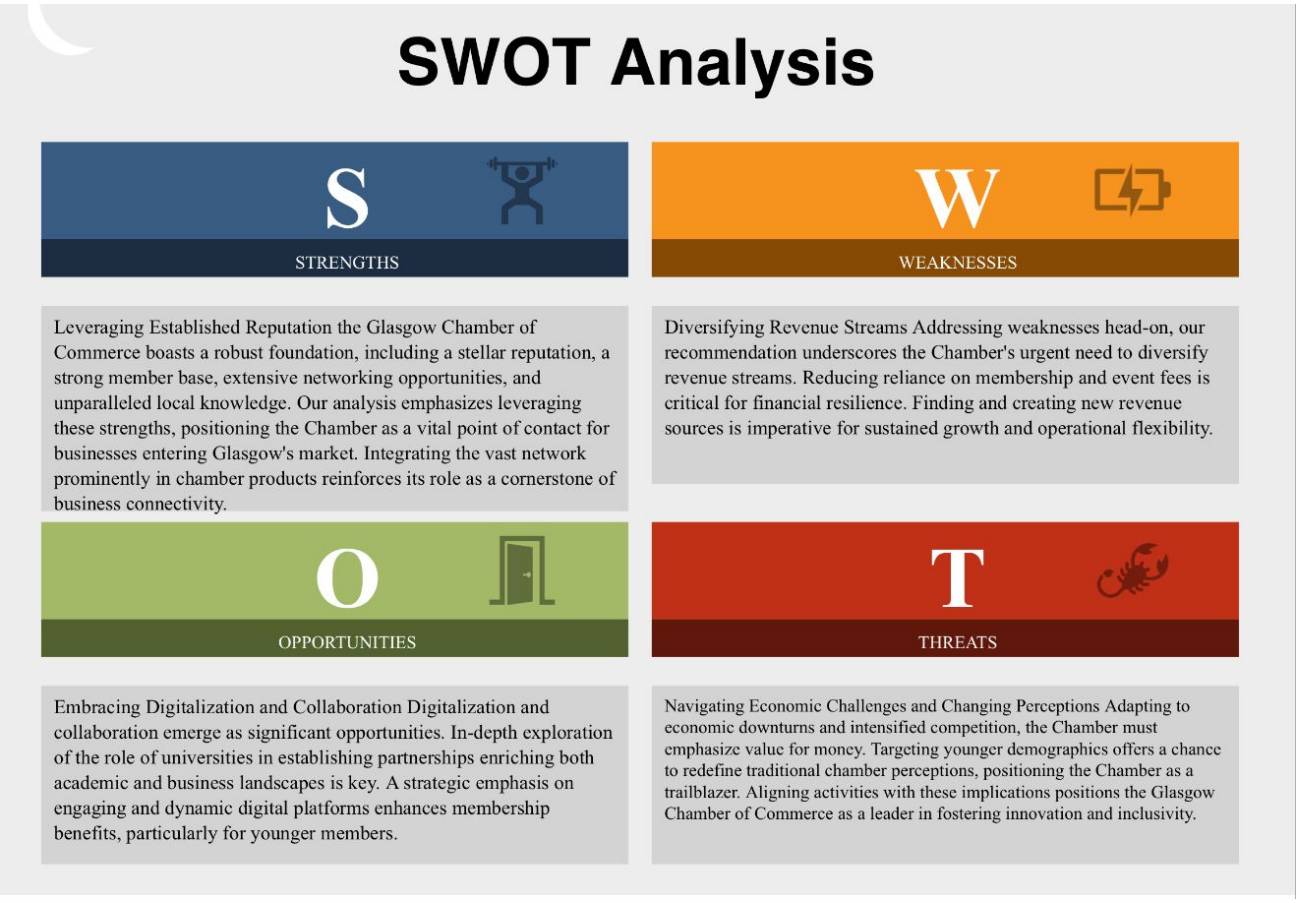
The Chamber's strategic intent is to cultivate a robust support ecosystem. Beyond networking, our recommendations include comprehensive programs fostering mentorship, knowledge exchange, and mutual assistance. Nurturing a collaborative environment aims to fortify bonds, creating a dynamic ecosystem for collective growth.

The subsequent sections detail strategies and initiatives, providing a roadmap for the Chamber's journey towards a more inclusive, vibrant, and future-ready organization. Together, these proposals craft a narrative of resilience, connectivity, and growth for the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce.

ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

Analysis and Findings: SWOT and Implications

Identification:



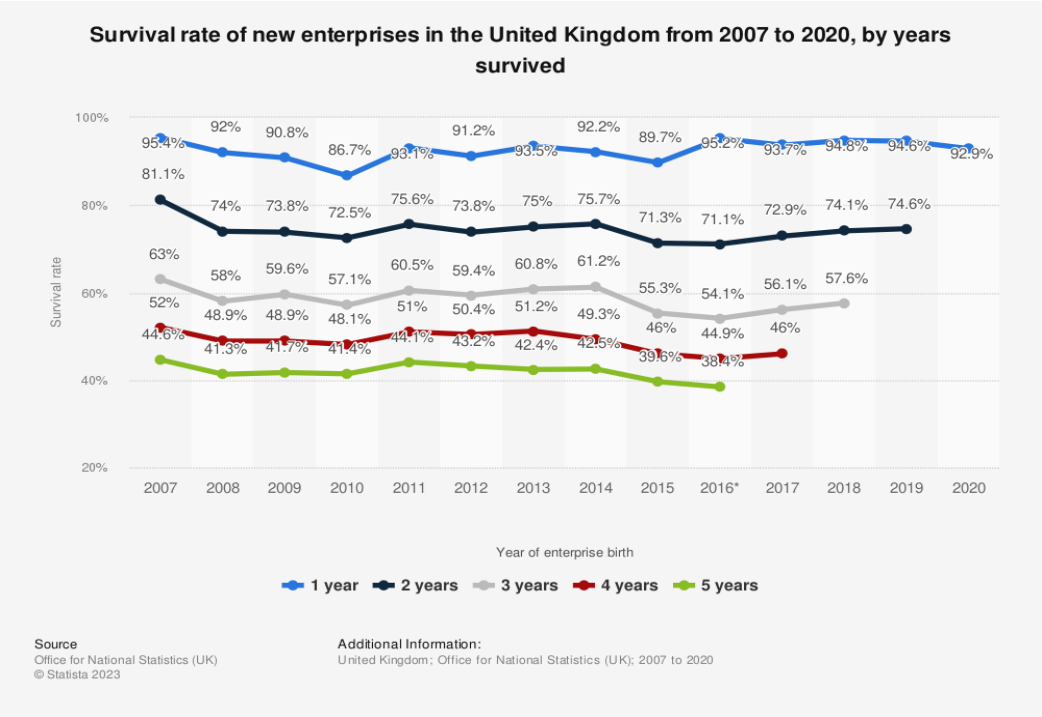
Targeting Growth Markets: Universities and Start-ups

Universities and Start-ups our analysis emphasizes the pivotal role universities and start-ups can play in propelling the Chamber into a new era of growth. Focused attention on these dynamic markets aligns seamlessly with the Chamber's objectives.

Universities: Unlocking the Potential of Youthful Ambition With six universities contributing to Glasgow's academic landscape, our recommendation centres on forging connections with university societies. These gateways offer direct access to engaged and aspiring students, tapping into their energy and enthusiasm.

Start-ups: Nurturing Innovation and Resilience The start-up ecosystem is a strategic focus. Understanding critical pain points leading to start-up failure, our recommendation emphasizes the Chamber's role as a catalyst for success. Leveraging Glasgow's position as a top-three tech investment hub positions the Chamber as a pivotal player in the regional start-up ecosystem. It can be seen from the figure below, that the average survival rate in UK start-ups reduced significantly from 74% in the Second year to 57% by the end of the third year. This further proves start-ups in the UK need assistance to survive.

In essence, our primary recommendation encourages the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce to strategically target growth markets, leveraging the untapped potential of universities and start-ups for mutual prosperity and sustained community development.



RECOMMENDATIONS

RECOMMENDATION 1 INTRODUCING INNOVATIVE MEMBERSHIP OFFERINGS

To meet the dynamic needs of our members and adapt to the changing business environment, we recommend the introduction of two distinctive membership tiers, reflecting your commitment to innovation and responsiveness to member aspirations.

1. **'Future Face' Membership - £150/year:** Tailored for individuals aspiring to advance their careers and broaden their professional networks, the 'Future Face' membership, priced at £150 annually, grants exclusive access to events designed for career growth and networking.

Membership Benefits:

- **Interactive Details:** Access specially designed sessions for meaningful interactions with industry peers, mentors, and potential partners.
- **Career Development Sessions:** Participate in workshops, seminars, and webinars focusing on critical skills, leadership, and personal growth.
- **Contextual Content:** Enjoy industry-specific content, including news, webinars, and resources to keep members informed about trends and career opportunities.
- **Discounts and Partnerships:** We offer special discounts on professional development courses, seminars, and services through our partnerships.

2. **'Start-up' Membership - £250/year:** Targeting businesses operational for a minimum of 24 months seeking to scale and thrive, the £250 per year 'Start-up' membership provides specialized support for start-up growth.

Membership Benefits:

- **Expert Advice:** Seek guidance from experienced professionals in marketing, finance, and operations to navigate challenges associated with growth.
- **Access to Funding:** Receive a curated list of potential investors, grant opportunities, and funding sources to fuel business expansion.

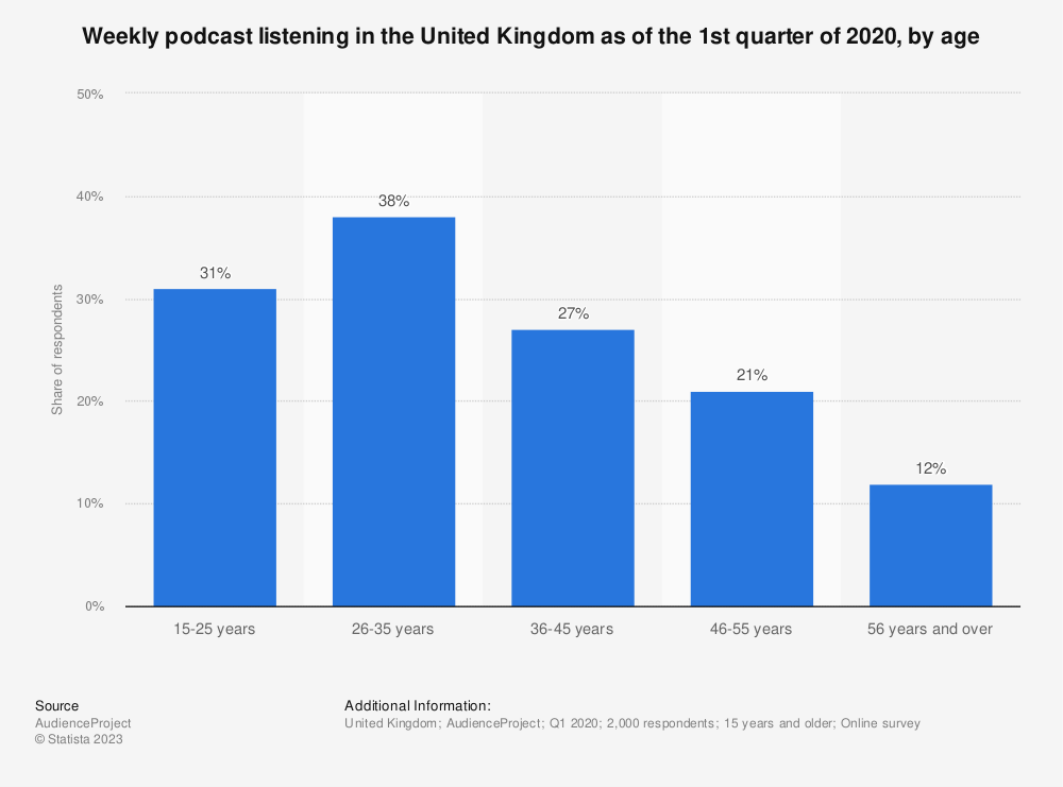
- **Connecting with Investors and Mentors:** Network with potential investors, mentors, and industry experts offering valuable insights and financial assistance.
- **Market Expansion Workshops:** Attend workshops and seminars focused on market expansion strategies and international development.

This membership model, successfully implemented by other chambers like the Birmingham Chamber of Commerce, aligns with industry trends and promises exceptional value for our members, ensuring the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce will remain at the forefront of innovation and service delivery.

RECOMMENDATION 2- STUDENT AMBASSADOR

Student ambassadors play a crucial role in building trust among prospective students through their authenticity, offering first-hand experiences that aid decision-making. Their reliability, grounded in current student status, involves sharing experiences transparently, fostering relationships and credibility. Serving as brand advocates, these ambassadors create positive buzz, enhancing brand awareness and trust. They contribute significantly to market research, providing insights into preferences and trends, and guiding product development and marketing strategies. Their role in maintaining a feedback loop is crucial for real-time campaign adjustments. With a knack for content creation, they produce authentic user-generated content, facilitating campus engagement and events targeting college demographics. This cost-effective strategy leverages student incentives for active participation. Student ambassadors, with diverse backgrounds, effectively reach various student segments, influencing purchasing decisions through trusted peer recommendations. Beyond marketing, the role offers skill development, fostering communication, leadership, and teamwork. It provides networking opportunities with professionals and peers, enhancing resumes and showcasing dedication to education and community involvement. This multifaceted role boosts personal confidence, refines networking skills, and aligns with diverse career paths, complementing chamber events and initiatives.

RECOMMENDATION 3- PODCAST

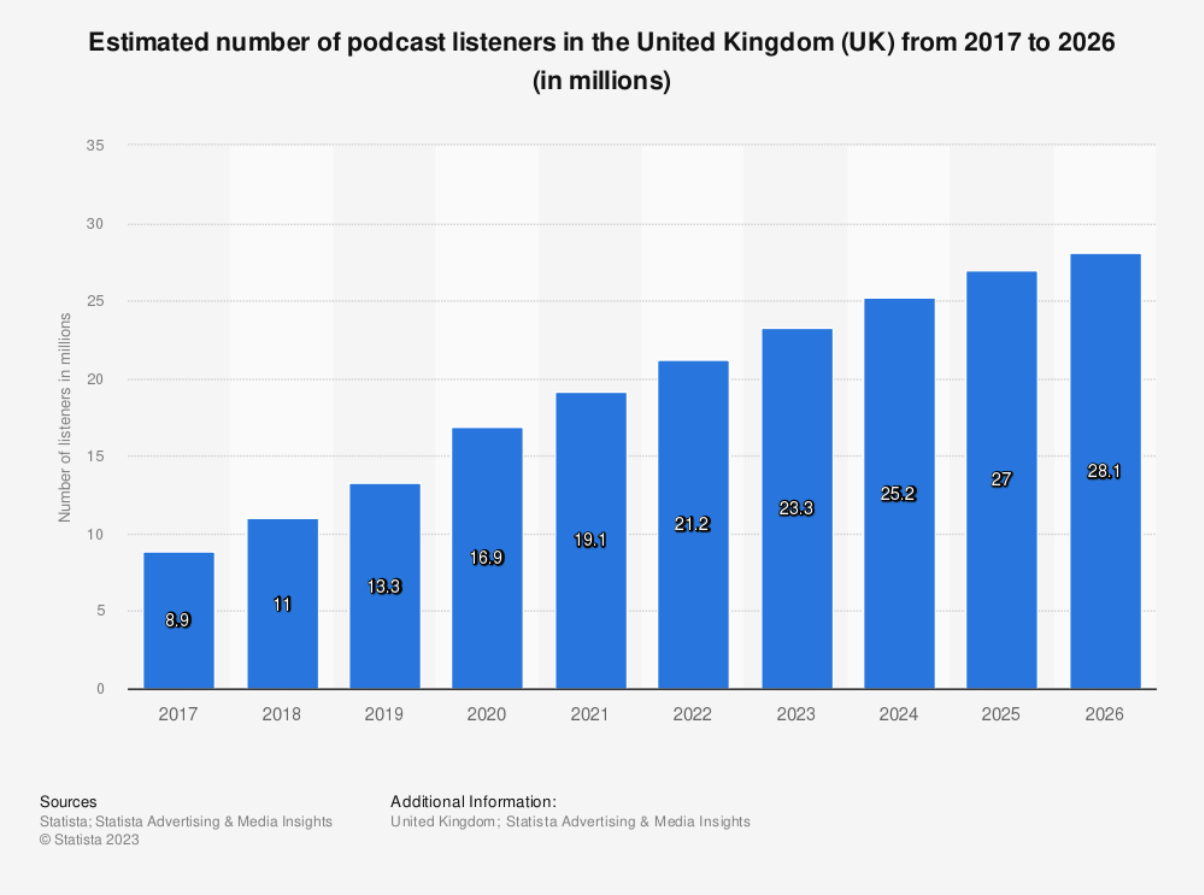


The analysis of two referenced articles reveals a significant surge in podcast listenership in the UK, notably among individuals aged 15-25 (31%) and those aged 26-35 (38%). Presently, 23.3 million people engage with podcasts, with an anticipated growth to 28.1 million by 2026, highlighting the medium's importance as a knowledge-sharing platform. Statista (2023).

Hence, proposing the establishment of a Glasgow Chamber of Commerce podcast channel becomes imperative. This initiative aims to curate content specifically addressing the informational needs of Glasgow's business community, covering local business news, emerging trends, regulatory changes, international trade, and detailed explanations of government-implemented rules weekly. The podcast serves as a reliable information hub for Glasgow's business professionals.

The content strategy involves hosting influencers, small business owners, achievers, and chamber alumni for discussions and casual conversations, adding substantial value to the

organization. This innovative endeavour enhances the Chamber's brand and attracts young professionals seeking insightful content. The podcast channel, offering a distinct format, is poised to contribute to revenue generation through sponsorships, advertising, affiliate marketing, premium content, and promotions. This multifaceted approach positions the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce as a pioneer, establishing a reputable brand and fostering financial sustainability.



RECOMMENDATION 4 – DEDICATED APP

The Glasgow Chamber of Commerce aims for strategic advancement by introducing its dedicated app, drawing inspiration from the pioneering London and British Chambers of Commerce. This fourth recommendation positions the Glasgow Chamber as an innovator, enhancing member engagement through the following key value propositions:

1. **Mentorship Platform:** The app establishes a dedicated space for mentorship programs, connecting seasoned professionals with aspiring entrepreneurs.
2. **Job and Internship Postings:** Serving as a hub for career growth, the app connects members with valuable job and internship opportunities within the Glasgow business community.
3. **Private Chat and Networking (Members Only):** The exclusive in-app chat function provides a secure space for real-time communication, encouraging networking and connections among members.
4. **Training Courses:** The app functions as a centralized platform for training courses, ensuring members have easy access to continuous learning and professional development.
5. **Blogs and Podcast Links:** Offering a curated resource library, the app connects members with insightful blogs and podcast links, keeping them informed about industry trends.

Members stand to gain substantial value from the app, including:

1. **Community Building:** Creating a virtual space that fosters a sense of community among members, transcending physical boundaries.
2. **Eco-System of Support:** Contributing to the creation of a robust ecosystem of support, where members can seek guidance and collaboration.
3. **Learning and Development:** Continuous learning opportunities enhance members' skills and keep them abreast of industry advancements.
4. **Instant Responses:** Real-time communication provides members with instant responses to queries, fostering a responsive and dynamic community.
5. **Valuable Contents and Resources:** Access to a wealth of valuable content and resources consolidates the Chamber's position as a go-to source for business insights.

6. **Exclusive In-App Chat:** Restricted to members, this feature enhances security and privacy, serving as an incentive for individuals to become members and reinforcing the exclusivity and value of Chamber membership.
7. **Industry-Specific Member Search:** Through the app, members can search for fellow members within the same industry, facilitating targeted networking and collaboration opportunities.

RECOMMENDATION 5 – 2 NEW EVENTS IDEAS

"Idea Meets Capital" serves as a linchpin in the start-up ecosystem, offering entrepreneurs access to substantial capital that propels growth, facilitates talent acquisition, and supports crucial areas like product development and marketing. Events such as Idea Meets Capital play a crucial role in networking, connecting entrepreneurs with professionals and broadening future career prospects. Venture capital funding, a cornerstone of innovation, not only sparks new industries but also catalyses economic revitalization, providing start-ups with flexible financing options such as equity financing and convertible debt tailored to their specific needs.

Hosting Idea Meets Capital events in Glasgow holds far-reaching implications for the local economy. By attracting investors and entrepreneurs, these events stimulate increased investment in local businesses, leading to job creation and promoting the city's digital and creative tech economy. Additionally, they offer valuable networking opportunities, fostering connections that contribute to professional growth. The innovative ideas generated can breathe new life into struggling economies, thereby augmenting the Chamber's membership, especially in categories like Future Face and Start-up.

On the other hand, a **"Wisdom Quest"** represents a unique gathering that brings seasoned industrial specialists together with rising stars and students seeking career guidance and mentorship. This event, designed for meaningful interactions, knowledge exchange, and mentorship opportunities, provides a relaxed and approachable atmosphere. Participants engage in unstructured networking, seeking advice, asking questions, and discussing career aspirations. Roundtable discussions or small group sessions, guided by experts, deepen these

interactions. A moderated Q&A panel session broadens the discussion horizon. Benefits include knowledge acquisition, expanded professional networks, increased confidence, and significant personal and professional growth.

An "Industry Mentorship Mixer" or "Career Chat" event provides a dynamic platform for participants to interact with industrial specialists, fostering knowledge sharing, mentorship, networking, and inspiration. Revenue opportunities arise through ticket sales to students and young professionals eager for industrial insights. This event serves as a strategic avenue to advertise the Future Rising Star program and allows speakers to promote their businesses, creating a symbiotic relationship between revenue generation and promotional activities.

CONCLUSION: CHARTING A COURSE FOR CHAMBER EXCELLENCE

In navigating Glasgow's dynamic business landscape, our recommendations are strategically designed to propel the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce into a future characterized by vibrancy, inclusivity, and sustained growth.

Membership Evolution: Our first recommendation introduces innovative membership tiers—' Future Face' and 'Startup.' These tailored memberships align with diverse member aspirations, positioning the Chamber as forward-thinking. By offering targeted benefits and exclusive opportunities, we aim to enhance member satisfaction and engagement, creating a more dynamic and inclusive community.

Student Ambassador Program: Recognizing the impact of student ambassadors, our second recommendation provides a cost-effective strategy to connect with the younger demographic. Leveraging the authenticity of student ambassadors adds a personal touch to outreach efforts, amplifying the Chamber's brand presence and gaining valuable insights into student preferences.

Podcast Initiative: The third recommendation capitalizes on the surging popularity of podcasts. Establishing a dedicated podcast channel positions the Chamber as a trusted source of business information, catering to the growing podcast audience. This initiative not only enhances brand authority but also opens revenue avenues through sponsorships and advertising.

Chamber App Development: Our fourth recommendation places the Chamber at the forefront of technological innovation. The proposed app offers a comprehensive platform with exclusive features for members, providing mentorship opportunities, job postings, private networking, training courses, and curated content. The app becomes a compelling reason for individuals to join, fostering a sense of community.

Idea Meets Capital and Wisdom Quest Events: The final recommendation involves hosting 'Idea Meets Capital' events and 'Wisdom Quests' to attract investors, entrepreneurs, and professionals. These events inject vitality into Glasgow's start-up ecosystem, positioning the Chamber as a key player in fostering innovation, economic growth, and valuable networking opportunities.

Embracing these recommendations, the Glasgow Chamber of Commerce can pave the way for a future marked by resilience, relevance, and a thriving, interconnected business community. Each proposal serves as a vital building block in the Chamber's transformative journey, propelling it toward a dynamic and impactful role in shaping Glasgow's business landscape.

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